

QUIZ 01

Am I Imagining This, or Is Something Actually Wrong?

22 questions · Multiple choice · Scenario-based

This quiz measures patterns, not people. No clinical language. No diagnoses. Just a clearer picture of what you may be experiencing.

Before you begin: Bring to mind a specific person you have a difficult or challenging relationship with. As you move through these questions, hold that person in mind and answer with them in view.

Answer based on what you consistently experience with this person, not your best or worst moments.

SECTION 01

Internal Experience

Q01 After interactions with this person, do you feel more confused than before? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

Q02 Do you replay conversations in your head trying to work out what just happened? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

Q03 Do you trust your own memory and judgment less than you used to? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

Q04 Do you feel like you're constantly explaining yourself but never feeling understood? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

Q05 Do you leave interactions feeling like you did something wrong, even when you can't name what? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

SECTION 02

Communication Patterns

Q06 When you raise concerns, are they dismissed, minimised, or turned back on you? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

Q07 Has this person told you something didn't happen the way you remember it — and made you doubt yourself? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

Q08 Are your emotional reactions framed as the real problem? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

Q09 Do apologies, if they happen, feel vague, conditional, performative, or short-lived? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

Q10 Do conversations about issues go in circles without resolution? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

SECTION 03

Push–Pull & Emotional Bonding

Q11 Are there periods where this person is warm, attentive, or remorseful, followed by withdrawal or criticism? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

Q12 Do you feel relieved when things are "good again," even though nothing has actually changed? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

Q13 Do you find yourself holding onto who they can be rather than who they consistently are? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

Q14 Does the idea of leaving feel harder than it logically should? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

Q15 Do you feel emotionally hooked despite knowing something isn't right? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

SECTION 04

Power & Reality

Q16 Does this person tend to treat their perspective as the accurate, more rational, or more mature one? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

Q17 Are your needs framed as excessive, selfish, or unreasonable? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

Q18 Do you find yourself adjusting your behaviour to avoid conflict or fallout? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

Q19 Has your version of reality been repeatedly questioned or reframed? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

Q20 Do you feel you've lost parts of yourself over time? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

SECTION 05

Orientation Check

Two final questions — these ones are worth sitting with.

Q21 Do you feel clearer and more grounded when you spend time away from this person? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

Q22 If a close friend described this relationship to you, would you be concerned? *No / Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Almost Always*

YOUR RESULTS

What Your Answers May Reveal

RESULT 01

You're Caught in a Confusion Loop

This result suggests you may be caught in a dynamic where your perception has been repeatedly disrupted over time.

Rather than clear conflict or obvious cruelty, the defining feature here is *confusion*. Moments of clarity are often followed by self-doubt. You may feel pulled between what you sense is true and what you're told is happening.

This kind of loop doesn't form because someone is weak or naive. It forms when insight, explanation, or emotional connection is offered just enough to keep hope alive, but never enough to create lasting resolution.

Many people in this dynamic describe feeling mentally exhausted, second-guessing themselves, and wondering why things that seem simple never quite settle.

What you're experiencing has a name — *reality distortion* — and naming it is often the first moment where the fog begins to lift.

NEXT STEP

A Field Guide to Reality Distortion is the next part of this journey. It walks you through the eight mechanisms that produce this kind of confusion, named one by one, so you can see what's been happening underneath your interactions. Most people read it and feel something settle for the first time in a long while.

[LINK]

RESULT 02

You May Be Bonded to Inconsistency

This result points to a relationship dynamic shaped by inconsistency.

Periods of warmth, connection, remorse, or closeness may be followed by withdrawal, criticism, or emotional distance. When things are "good," they feel meaningful and relieving. When they're not, you may find yourself waiting for the good version to return.

The nervous system learns to stay alert, hopeful, and invested. Not because you've chosen to. Because that's how attachment works under conditions of unpredictability.

People in this dynamic often know something isn't right, yet feel unusually attached, loyal, or unable to disengage without distress.

Understanding this pattern can explain why leaving, pulling back, or emotionally detaching feels far harder than logic alone would suggest. This is a specific kind of bonding that forms when relief and rupture cycle through the same relationship.

NEXT STEP

A Field Guide to Reality Distortion has a chapter on exactly this — *The Bond That Forms Without Your Consent* — that explains the neuroscience of why this attachment is so strong, and why it loosens not through force, but through accuracy. If you've ever wondered why you can see what's happening and still feel unable to walk away, this is the chapter that names it.

[LINK]

RESULT 03

You May Be Inside a Reality Distortion Pattern

This result suggests a dynamic where power, authority, or control over the narrative plays a significant role.

You may notice that your needs are regularly reframed as unreasonable, your reactions are treated as the real issue, or your version of events is subtly overridden. Over time, this can lead to adjusting yourself to maintain peace or avoid fallout.

This pattern isn't always loud or overt. It often shows up as one person positioning themselves as more rational, evolved, knowledgeable, or reasonable, while the other slowly becomes less confident in their own perspective.

People in this dynamic frequently feel smaller, quieter, or less sure of themselves than they once were.

Recognising this pattern can help explain why asserting yourself hasn't led to mutual understanding, and why the burden of change has always landed on you.

NEXT STEP

A Field Guide to Reality Distortion is where this gets unpacked properly. It names the specific mechanisms that produce this kind of dynamic — how meaning gets controlled, how your reality gets quietly overridden, and what shifts when you stop trying to be understood by someone whose understanding was never the goal.

It's the orientation that comes before anything else.

[LINK]

RESULT 04

What You're Describing Doesn't Strongly Match This Pattern

This result suggests that, based on your responses, the patterns measured in this quiz aren't strongly present.

That doesn't mean your relationship is perfect, or that there are no challenges worth addressing. All relationships involve conflict, miscommunication, and moments of hurt.

What's important here is that this result doesn't point to a sustained dynamic of confusion, erosion of self-trust, or reality disruption over time.

It may be worth exploring what's making things feel unsettled — not every difficult relationship fits a single pattern, and that clarity has value too.

Sometimes clarity comes from recognising what *isn't* happening just as much as what is.

NEXT STEP

If you'd like to read more about the patterns this quiz was screening for — even just to rule them out with a clearer lens — *A Field Guide to Reality Distortion* walks through them in detail. It's also useful for understanding dynamics you may be witnessing in other relationships around you, even if they aren't your own.

[LINK]

This quiz is for educational and self-reflection purposes only. It does not constitute a clinical diagnosis or professional assessment. If you are experiencing distress, please seek support from a qualified mental health professional.